

around compliance. This is called the OpenChain Curriculum and it helps organisations meet the requirements of the OpenChain Specification.

Q What were the major challenges you faced while building this project?

Initially, while building the project, we thought that perhaps a big checklist would solve the supply chain problems; so the one that was created had over 100 items. While that represented a clean list of great items to cover, in the real market there was a lack of infrastructure knowledge to implement. Narrowing the wish list down to easy-to-accomplish goals was a significant challenge.

Q What are the standards and frameworks that have been introduced in the last one year and how are these different from the OpenChain Project?

The OpenChain Project is the only standard related to open source compliance in the software supply chain. There are many tools and systems being introduced for practical activities like scanning and record keeping, which have also helped in building the ecosystem.

Q What is the feedback from companies that use the OpenChain Project?

Companies really like the OpenChain Project's approach and there is interest in making it a formal standard within a body, like the International Organisation for Standardisation (ISO). Being a formal standard can be useful for procurement, in the long run. Another bit of feedback is that companies find it useful to be able to call on outside organisations to check conformance, and we have developed a partner programme to address this. Organisations anywhere can adopt OpenChain easily on their own, but if they wish, they can also get help. The OpenChain Project has very little to no barriers to entry for entities of all sizes.

Q What was the cost of implementing this project?

The OpenChain Project was created and refined by an extensive community of volunteers who wanted to share their knowledge; so from the cost perspective, it was cheap. The contributors had a clear vision of the value because they knew the OpenChain Specification would be directly beneficial to their business areas, in the long run. The primary spending is for outreach and workshops.

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Q What lies on the road ahead for the Linux Foundation in terms of technologies and applications?

Many companies are expressing interest in collaborating with us, so we are working on multiple projects, simultaneously. For the OpenChain Project specifically, we expect to become a formal standard in the coming years. Along with this, we are planning on extensive localisation of all our materials. Large strides will be taken in this respect during 2018.

Q What is your advice to future developers who are working with open source?

My advice to future developers is to work with projects like OpenChain and with organisations like the Linux Foundation. This will help them move in the right direction to accomplish their goals. This will also help them use their time efficiently and get better results at their organisation. **END** 🐧

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